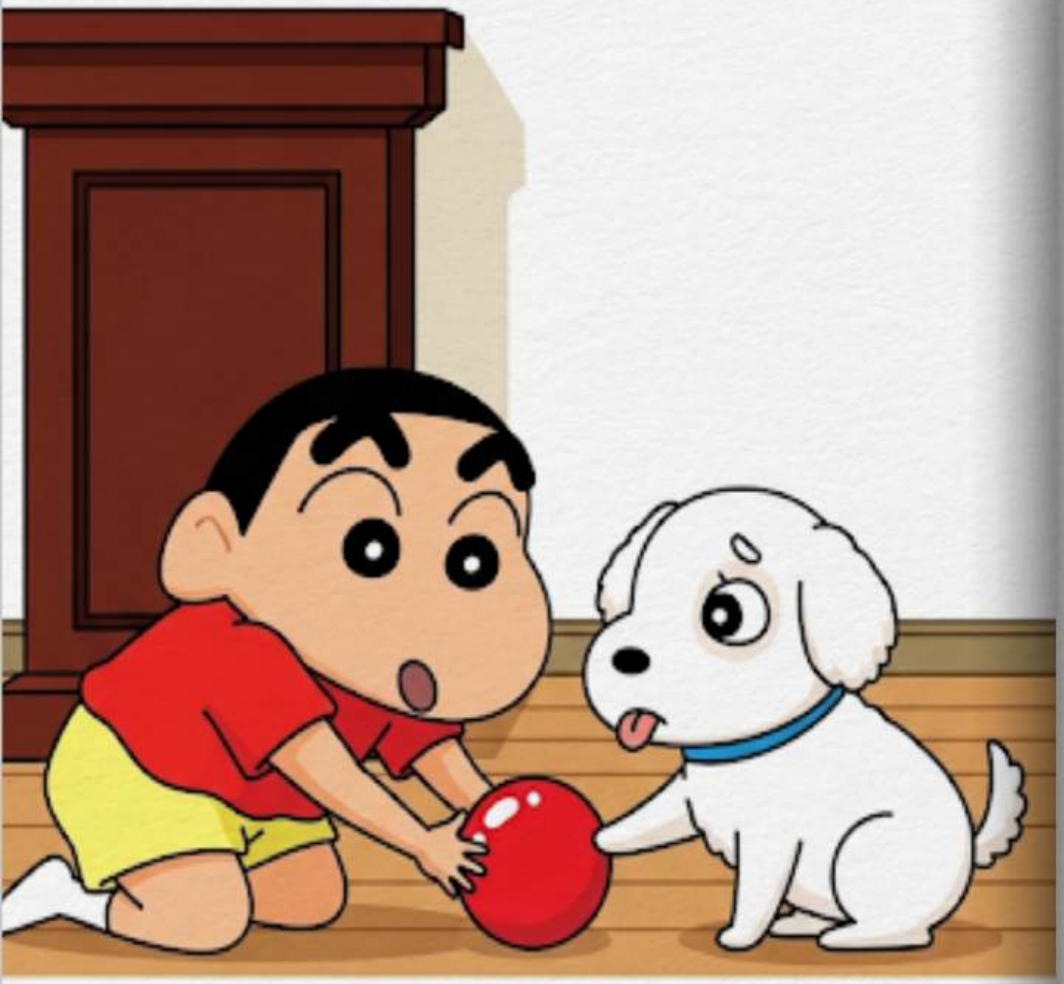
Shin and the Mystery of the Blue Vase

By Palak Kamthan

It was a sunny afternoon in the Kasukabe house. Shin was feeling very energetic. He had a bright red bouncy ball that went "Boing! Boing! Boing!" across the living room. His mom, Mitsu, looked up from her book and shook her finger. "Be careful, Shin! No bouncing balls near my favorite blue vase!"

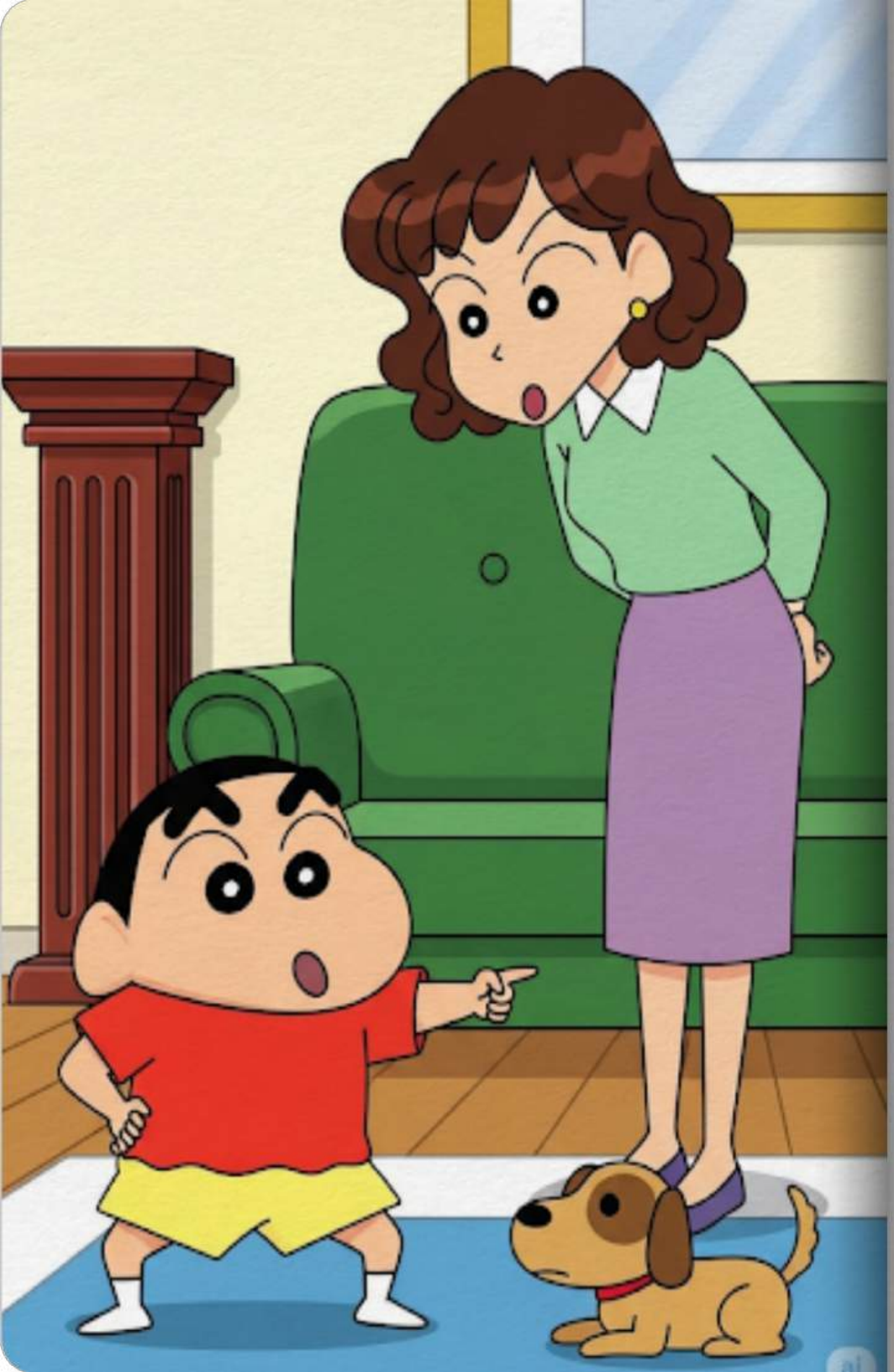
Shin tried to be careful, but his feet had a mind of their own. He gave the ball one giant, super-duper kick. The ball zoomed past the sofa, zipped over the table, and—CRASH! It hit the beautiful blue vase. The vase wobbled, tipped, and shattered into a hundred shiny pieces on the floor.

Shin stared at the mess. Just then, his little white dog, Cloud, trotted into the room. Cloud wagged his tail and sniffed a piece of the broken glass. Shin's brain started spinning like a top. He didn't want to be in trouble. He didn't want to lose his dessert!

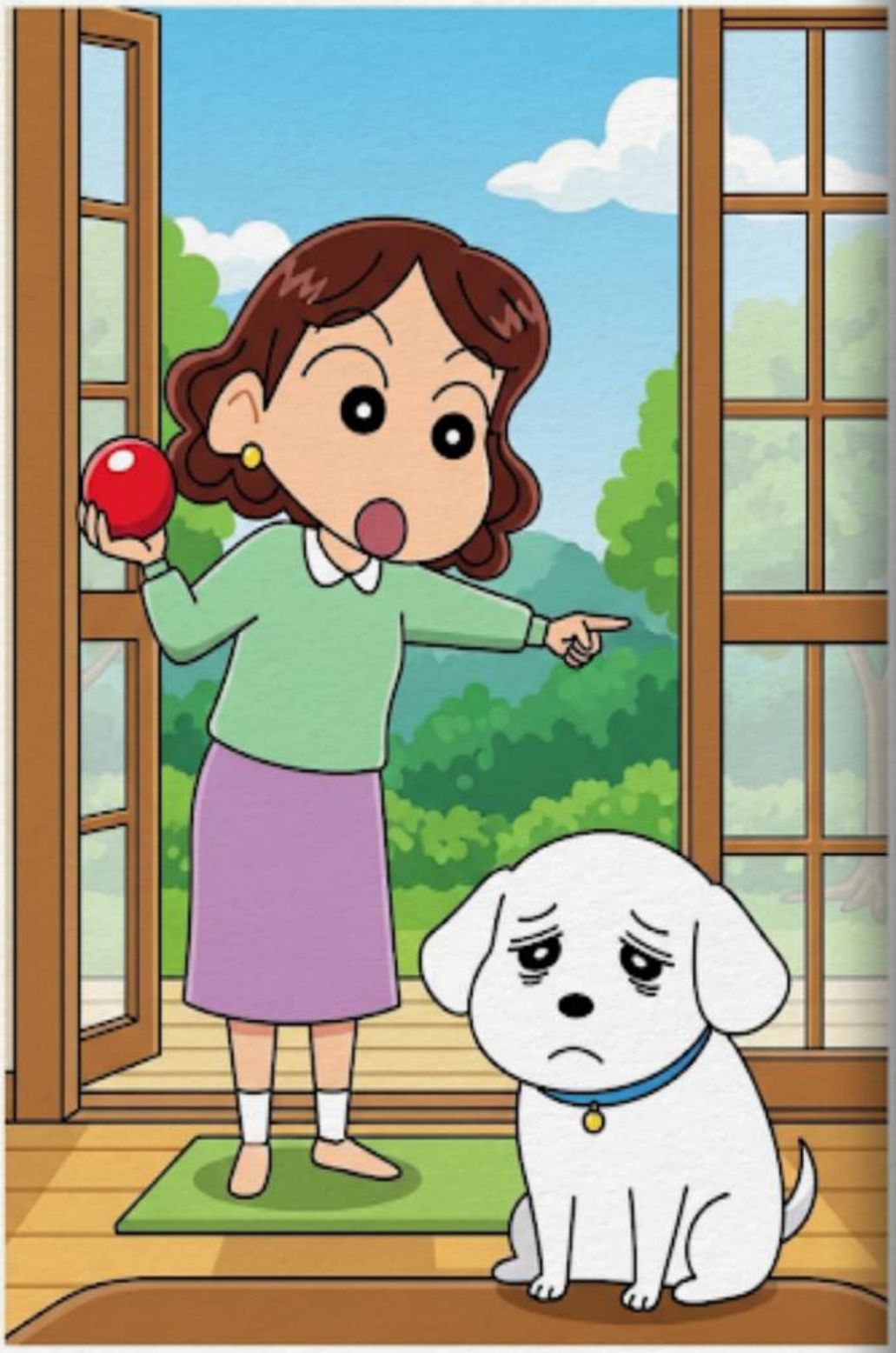


Shin had a very naughty idea. He picked up his red ball and tucked it right under Cloud's paw. "Sorry, Cloud," Shin whispered. "But you're a dog! Mom can't take away a dog's chocolate cookies, because dogs don't even eat them!" He tried to look as innocent as a little angel.

Mitsu heard the noise and rushed into the room. She saw the empty pedestal and the blue pieces scattered everywhere. Her eyes went wide, and her shoulders slumped. "Oh no!" she cried. "My favorite vase is broken!" She looked very, very sad.

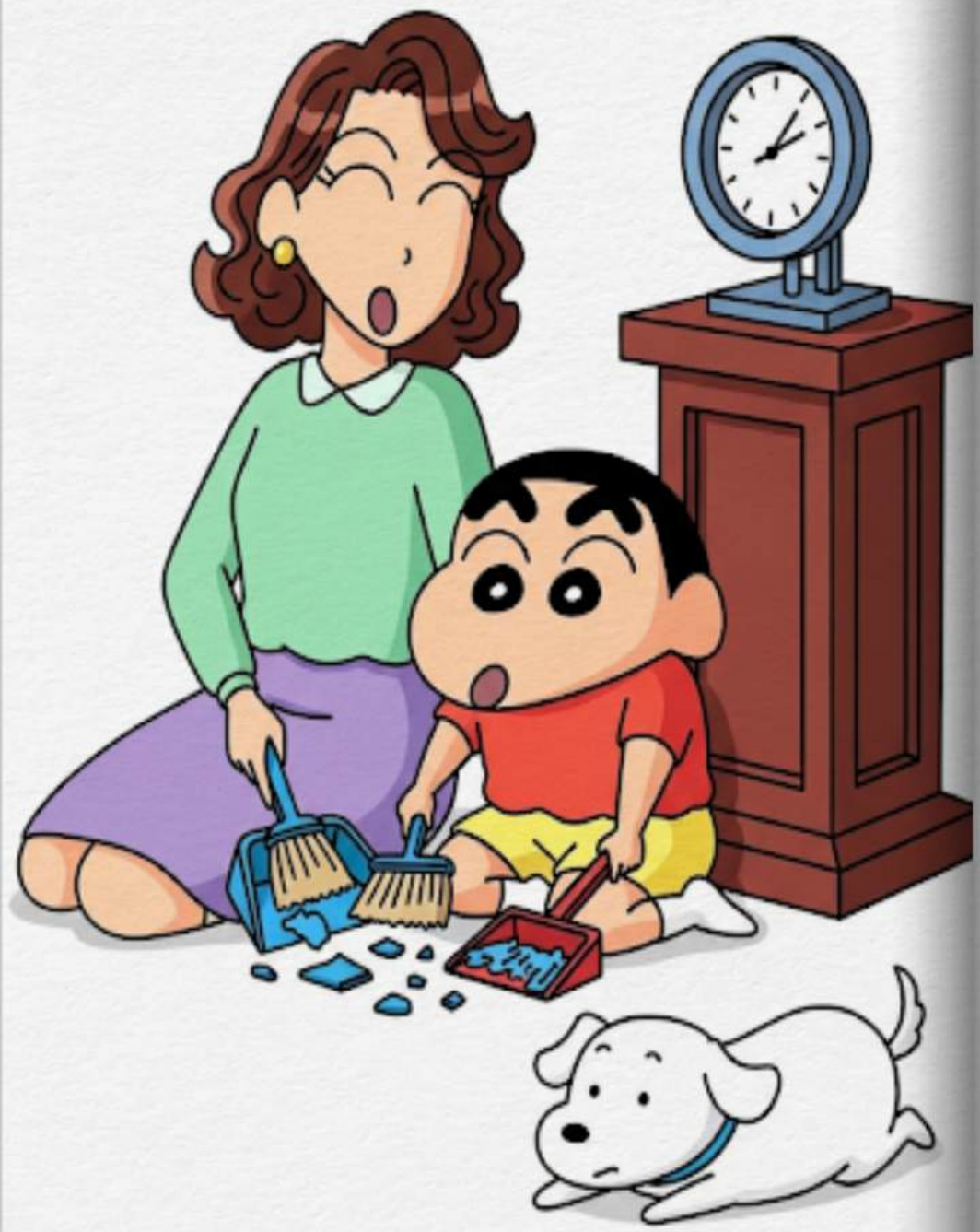


Mitsu looked at Shin. "Shin, what happened here?" Shin did a little wiggle and pointed his finger. "It wasn't me, Mom! It was the Great White Wolf, Cloud! He did a karate kick and—BAM! The vase went kaboom! See? He's even holding the ball!"



Mitsu sighed. "If Cloud is being a 'Great White Wolf,' then he can't have any doggy treats today. And he has to stay outside in the garden until dinner time." She walked over to Cloud and picked up the red ball. Poor Cloud let out a tiny, sad whimper.

Shin watched Cloud walk slowly toward the garden. Usually, Cloud would bark and play, but now he just sat by the glass door, looking lonely. Shin felt a strange, itchy feeling in his tummy. It wasn't hunger for cookies. It was a "guilty-itch."



Mitsu gave a long sigh, but then she smiled. She knelt down and hugged Shin. "I'm sad about the vase, Shin, but I'm very happy you told the truth. Being honest is much more important than a vase." Shin helped her sweep up the pieces, and afterward, they even shared a cookie with Cloud.